



Day 7 Notes

Shopping Cart: Context and localStorage (My Recap)

★ Today = I built the shopping cart. My product pages from Day 6 were merged into main, so I started a fresh branch for this new feature.

1 Starting Clean

```
cd Desktop\virtual_tryon
git checkout main
git pull                → get the merged work
git checkout -b feature/cart → new branch for today
cd client
npm install             → install anything new
```

My old branch feature/store was finished and merged. If I kept building on it, I'd be working on OLD code. A new feature gets a new branch, made from the latest main.

2 What I Built (Cart Only)

- An Add to cart button on the product detail page
- A Cart page at /cart: each item with image, name, price, quantity + and - buttons, and a remove button
- A total price, and a friendly message when the cart is empty
- A header on every page with a Cart link that shows how many items are inside

No checkout or payment yet, and no server changes. One feature at a time.

3 New Idea: React Context

Problem: the cart is needed in many places. The detail page ADDS to it, the cart page SHOWS it, and the header shows the COUNT. Passing it through props to every component would be messy.

React Context = one shared box. Any component can read from it or change it, without props.

```
// a simple example (the real file is bigger)
const CartContext = createContext()

// any component can then use it
const { addToCart } = useContext(CartContext)
```

- createContext → makes the shared box
- Provider → wraps the app, so every page can reach the box
- useContext → how a component opens the box

4 The Cart Functions

- addToCart → adds a product (or raises its quantity if it's already there)
- removeFromCart → takes an item out
- updateQuantity → the + and - buttons
- clearCart → empties everything
- total price → add up (price x quantity) for every item
- item count → the number shown in the header

5 New Idea: localStorage

React state is forgotten when I refresh the page. localStorage is a small storage space INSIDE the browser that stays after a refresh.

```
localStorage.setItem('cart', JSON.stringify(items))
const saved = JSON.parse(localStorage.getItem('cart'))
```

- localStorage only stores TEXT, so I turn the list into text with JSON.stringify and back with JSON.parse
- It lives in ONE browser on ONE computer. It is not on the server, so my cart won't follow me to another device.

6 Lesson from Day 6: Check the Work

Last time my pages were missing because the changes weren't finished or saved. So today:

- Don't close AntigraVity until the agent says it is done and lists its files
- Click Accept or Apply if it asks
- Run git status and look for new files. If it says nothing changed, stop and tell Fahad.

7 Testing Checklist

- Add to cart on a product → the header count goes up

- Cart page shows the item with its price
- + and - change the quantity, and the total updates
- Remove makes the item disappear
- Refresh the page → the cart is still there (that's localStorage)
- Empty cart → the friendly message shows

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Pushing and Merging

```
git add .  
git commit -m "Add shopping cart"  
git push -u origin feature/cart
```

Fahad checked the branch on GitHub and merged it into main with a pull request. After a merge, everyone updates their own laptop:

```
git checkout main  
git pull
```



Big takeaway:

New feature = new branch from the latest main. React Context shares data between pages without passing props everywhere. localStorage keeps data after a refresh, but only in that one browser. Always check git status to confirm the work was really saved. Next: checkout and orders, where the server will start saving real orders.

— made while building: AI Virtual Try-On E-commerce App —